

Billy's Bug Garden

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Billy had a small garden behind his house.

One morning he found tiny holes in his lettuce leaves.

"Oh no!" he said. "Something is eating my garden!"

He felt upset.

He looked closer.

A green caterpillar was munching away.

Munch, munch, munch.

Billy felt angry at first.

Then he felt curious.

"Why are you eating my lettuce, little caterpillar?" he asked.

The caterpillar just kept munching.

Billy looked under another leaf.

A ladybug was there, red with black spots.



"Hello, ladybug," said Billy.

The ladybug crawled onto his finger.

Tickle, tickle, tickle.

Billy giggled.

He felt his anger melt away.

Then he saw an ant carrying a crumb.

Then a bee humming over the flowers.

Then a worm wiggling in the soil.

"My garden is full of bugs," said Billy.

"Full, full, full," he said.

That was three times he said it.

He felt surprised.

He ran to ask his big sister.

"Are bugs bad for gardens?" he asked.



His sister laughed kindly.

"Some bugs munch leaves," she said.

"But ladybugs eat the munchers."

"Bees help flowers grow."

"Worms make the soil soft."

Billy felt thoughtful.

Maybe the bugs were not enemies.

Maybe they were neighbors.

He had an idea.

He planted extra lettuce at the edge of the garden.

"This row is for the caterpillars," he said.

"And this row is for me."

The caterpillar seemed to nod.

Munch, munch, went the caterpillar, happily now.



Billy watched the ladybug fly to a leaf.

He watched the bee visit every flower.

He watched the worm dive into the dark soil.

"Goodnight, bugs," whispered Billy as the sun set.

"Goodnight, goodnight, goodnight," he whispered.

That was three times again.

He felt peaceful.

The garden hummed softly in the evening air.

Sleep now, little gardener.

Dream of ladybugs with polka-dot wings.

Moral: *Sharing a little can make room for everyone.*

The End